

FIFA WORLD CUP 2026 · GROUP I · MATCH 61 · MATCHDAY 3

Norway vs France

Friday, June 26, 2026 · Kickoff 3:00 PM ET / 3:00 AM MYT (Jun 27) / 19:00 UTC ·

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough, MA · Referee: Michael Oliver (England).

Entertainment analysis only — not investment advice.

NOR

Norway

FIFA #31 · 6 pts · GD
+4 · Must win

VS

France

FIFA #3 · 6 pts · GD +5
· Draw = 1st

FRA

Lineups confirmed (Sofascore): June 26, 2026, pre-kickoff. Norway have made **massive rotation** — Haaland, Ødegaard, Berge, and Nusa all **benched**, clearly resting stars for the Round of 32. France near full strength under Guy Stephan (Deschamps absent). Exchange rate basis: ECB reference **1 EUR = 1.08 USD** (June 24, 2026). Pre-lineup odds verified from worldcup-2026.bet, TheSpread, and RefOdds snapshots. Score paths and betting allocations are **Assumed/Inference** beyond confirmed XIs.

Key Conclusions

Confirmed Rotation Shock

Haaland, Ødegaard, Berge, Nusa all benched. Norway field a B-team despite must-win stakes.

France ~65–70%

Pre-lineup ~170; effective win probability rises post-rotation. Mismatch now extreme.

Central Path: France 2-0

Clean sheet likely vs depleted Norway attack. Alt: France 1-0.

Tail: Set Piece / Haaland Sub

Norway B-team set-piece threat or late Haaland impact if brought on.

Verified: Confirmed XIs (Sofascore)

Verified: Fixture, Standings, Referee

Verified: Pre-Lineup Odds

Assumed: Post-Rotation Market Shift

CANCELLED: Prior CS 2-1 Selection

Concentrated Betting Plan

Budget: \$100 entertainment cap · **\$2 per unit** · 50 units total. Lineup news transforms this from a marquee shootout into a structural mismatch — France full strength vs Norway reserves.

⚠️ **Concentrated plans increase variance and may lose the entire entertainment budget. Prior Selection 2 (Correct Score Norway 2-1) is CANCELLED — Haaland benched.**

Score Thesis Summary

Pre-lineup market: France -170 (~63% implied). Post-rotation effective baseline: France -65-70%. Norway's confirmed B-team cannot sustain a high press against France's first-choice XI. Central path: **France 2-0** (clean sheet likely). Alternative: **France 1-0**. Tail: Norway set piece or Haaland sub impact. Style clash shifts toward **Under** — Norway B-team lacks transition threat.

~~GANGELLED—Original Selection 2: Correct Score Norway 2-1~~

~~Haaland benched. Thesis invalidated. Do not place.~~

VOID

Selection 1 (70%) – France Win & Under 3.5 Goals

35 units · France control vs Norway B-team; rotation suppresses Norway scoring ceiling. U3.5 aligns with 2-0 / 1-0 paths.

Min odds: +120 · **Cancel if:** Mbappé injured in warmup. Heavy rain at kickoff.

Selection 2 (30%) – France Clean Sheet (BTTS No + France Win)

15 units · Norway without Haaland/Ødegaard/Nusa starting;
France near full strength. BTTS No pre-lineup at ~+108 implied.

Min odds: +200 · **Cancel if:** Mbappé injured in warmup. Heavy rain.

\$70

35 u

\$30

15 u

10-Layer Score-Impact Table

#	Layer	Evidence	Direction
1	Market baseline	France –170 pre-lineup. Effective ~65–70% post-rotation.	UP France win
2	Football matchup	Extreme mismatch. France full strength vs Norway B-team.	UP France scoring
3	Officiating	Oliver moderate (3.75 YC/game career). WC 2026: NED 5-1 SWE, 3 yellows.	NO CHANGE
4	Environment	79°F, 71% humidity, cloudy, SSW 5–10 mph.	SLIGHT DOWN late tempo
5	Venue / crowd	Gillette Stadium, neutral site, open-air grass.	NO CHANGE
6	Emotion	Norway rotation confirms dead-rubber treatment despite must-win math. France motivated for group top.	UP France control
7	Disciplinary	No suspension concerns for either side.	NO CHANGE
8	Squad depth	France bench stronger than Norway starters. Massive quality gap.	UP France margin
9	Style clash	Norway B-team cannot sustain high press. France control game, not open transitions.	SHIFTS TOWARD Under
10	Sharp vs public	Pre-lineup lines may still offer value on France now that rotation is confirmed.	UP France value

Pre-Purchase Check

Condition	Action
Mbappé injured in warmup	Cancel both selections. Reassess France ML only if odds justify.
Heavy rain at kickoff	Reduce Selection 2; widen score range. Humidity already elevated.
Haaland starts (late change)	Reinstate tail only — do not restore cancelled CS 2-1 without full reassessment.

Condition	Action
France Win & U3.5 below +120	Do not force — mark Not recommended.
France CS combo below +200	Drop Selection 2; concentrate on Selection 1 at min threshold.

Referee & Environment Impact

Referee: Michael Oliver (England)

Verified FIFA assignment for Match 61.

Career average: **3.75 yellow cards/game, 22 fouls/game**.

WC 2026 sample (1 match): Netherlands 5-1 Sweden — 3 yellow cards. Moderate discipline profile; no extreme card or penalty skew.

Score adjustment: NO CHANGE on central France 2-0 path.

Match Environment

Venue: Gillette Stadium, Foxborough, MA — 64,628 capacity, natural grass, open-air.

Weather (kickoff): ~79°F, 71% humidity, cloudy, SSW winds 5–10 mph (Weather Underground).

Score adjustment: SLIGHT DOWN on late-game tempo — humidity may slow pressing intensity in final 20 minutes.

Factor	Evidence	Direction	Confidence
Open-air grass	79°F, 71% humidity	SLIGHT DOWN tempo late	Medium
Referee style	3.75 YC/game career; 3 YC in WC match	NO CHANGE	Medium
Norway rotation	Haaland, Ødegaard, Berge, Nusa benched	DOWN Norway scoring	High
France motivation	Near full-strength XI; group top on offer	UP France control	High

Event Background

Group I Context (After MD2)

Both Norway and France qualified with 6 points each. France lead on goal difference (+5 vs +4). A draw is sufficient for France to top Group I; Norway must win to claim first place. Senegal and Iraq eliminated (0 pts).

MD1: France 3-1 Senegal (MetLife); Iraq 1-4 Norway (Gillette). **MD2:** France 3-0 Iraq (Philadelphia); Norway 3-2 Senegal (MetLife).

Stakes & Narrative

On paper this was the marquee MD3 clash — Haaland vs Mbappé, both on 4 WC goals. Confirmed lineups rewrite the script: Norway's massive rotation signals prioritization of Round of 32 fitness over group-winner ambition. France, under assistant Guy Stephan with Deschamps absent, field a near full-strength XI motivated to secure group top.

H2H: 16 meetings — France 7W, Norway 5W, 4D. First-ever World Cup meeting.

Group Standings

Team	P	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Scenario
France	2	2	0	0	6	1	+5	6	Draw or win = 1st
Norway	2	2	0	0	7	3	+4	6	Must win for 1st
Senegal	2	0	0	2	3	6	-3	0	Eliminated
Iraq	2	0	0	2	1	7	-6	0	Eliminated

MD3 parallel fixture: Senegal vs Iraq (Toronto). Winner of Group I faces a third-placed team in R32; runner-up faces a group winner.

Team Overview

Norway

Coach **Ståle Solbakken** (FIFA #31). First World Cup since 1998. Squad value ~\$590M (Transfermarkt) — but confirmed XI omits the three most valuable players: Haaland (\$194M), Ødegaard (\$119M), and Nøse (\$49M).

Confirmed approach: 4-3-3 with Selvik, Bjørkan, Østgård, Falchener, Aursnes; Berg (c), Thorstvedt, Bobb; Aasgaard, Strand Larsen, Schjelderup. Rotation suggests R32 prioritization over group-winner chase.

Risk: Must-win on paper, but lineup contradicts urgency. B-team lacks firepower to break France's defense.

France

Guy Stephan in charge with Deschamps absent. FIFA #3, squad value ~\$1.64B. Near full-strength 4-2-3-1: Maignan; Koundé, Lacroix, Upamecano, T. Hernández; Tchouaméni, Koné; Dembélé, Olise, Doué; Mbappé (c).

Style: Controlled possession, wide overloads via Dembélé/Olise, Mbappé central runs. Bench depth (Saliba, Kanté, Thuram, Barcola) exceeds Norway's starting XI quality.

Motivation: Group top within reach; no reason to rotate against a depleted opponent.

Category	Norway	France
FIFA Ranking	#31	#3
Group Record	WW · 7 GF / 3 GA	WW · 6 GF / 1 GA
H2H (all-time)	16 meetings: France 7W, Norway 5W, 4D	
Confirmed XI strength	B-team (4 stars benched)	Near full strength
Motivation vs lineup	Must win — but rotation says otherwise	Win/draw for group top

Confirmed Starters & Tactics

Verified

Lineups confirmed via Sofascore, June 26, 2026.

● Norway (home) ● France (away)

▲ FRA 4-2-3-1 · Guy Stephan

16 Maignan

5 Koundé

26 Lacroix

23 Upamecano

19 T. Hernández

8 Tchouaméni

15 Koné

7 Dembélé

11 Olise

20 Doué

10 Mbappé (c)

19 Aasgaard

11 Strand Larsen

21 Schjelderup

6 Berg (c)

18 Thorstvedt

22 Bobb

15 Bjørkan

4 Østigård

25 Falchener

14 Aursnes

13 Selvik

▼ NOR 4-3-3 · Ståle Solbakken

Gillette · 79°F · Cloudy · SSW 5–10 mph

Confirmed benches:

Norway: Nyland, Tangvik, Ajer, Wolfe, Heggem, Langås, Pedersen, Thorsby, Berge,

Ødegaard, Ryerson, Hauge, Sørloth, *Haaland*, *Nusa* — stars in italics all benched.

France: Samba, Risser, Gusto, Digne, Konaté, Saliba, L. Hernández, Kanté, Rabiot, Zaire-Emery, Cherki, Aklouche, Thuram, Barcola, Mateta.

Tactical Lens	Watch	Betting Link
Norway rotation signal	Haaland, Ødegaard, Berge, Nusa all benched despite must-win math	Cancels Norway score paths; UP France win & clean sheet
France control	Tchouaméni/Koné pivot vs Berg/Thorstvedt — quality mismatch	France Win & U3.5 core thesis
Wide overloads	Dembélé/Olise vs Bjørkan/Falchener flanks	Supports France 2-0 central path
Late subs	Haaland/Nusa off bench if Norway trail	Tail risk only — do not restore cancelled CS 2-1

Full Rosters

26-man World Cup squads · Market values approximate USD (Transfermarkt, 1 EUR = 1.08 USD). ⭐ = benched star in confirmed XI.



Norway · FIFA #31

MANAGER



Ståle Solbakken

Head Coach

Norway · 4-3-3 · Massive MD3 rotation

FORWARDS



Erling Haaland ⭐ BENCHED

25 · \$194M

#9 · ST · 6'4" · Man City · 4 WC goals



Jørgen Strand Larsen

26 · \$30M

#11 · ST · 6'4" · Crystal Palace ·
STARTING



Alexander Sørloth ⭐ BENCHED

30 · \$38M

#7 · ST · 6'5" · Atlético Madrid



Andreas Schjelderup

22 · \$16M

#21 · LW · 5'8" · Benfica · STARTING



Antonio Nusa ⭐ BENCHED

21 · \$49M

#20 · LW · 5'11" · RB Leipzig



Jens Petter Hauge

26 · \$5M

#23 · LW · 5'10" · Bodø/Glimt

MIDFIELDERS



Martin Ødegaard ⭐ BENCHED

27 · \$119M

#10 · AM · 5'10" · Arsenal · Captain



Sander Berge ⭐ BENCHED

28 · \$24M

#8 · DM · 6'5" · Fulham



France · FIFA #3

MANAGER



Guy Stephan (Deschamps absent)

Head Coach (interim)

4-2-3-1 · Near full-strength XI

FORWARDS



Kyllian Mbappé (c)

27 · \$194M

#10 · ST · 5'10" · Real Madrid · 4 WC
goals · STARTING



Ousmane Dembélé

29 · \$130M

#7 · RW · 5'10" · PSG · STARTING



Michael Olise

24 · \$108M

#11 · AM · 6'0" · Bayern Munich ·
STARTING



Désiré Doué

21 · \$49M

#20 · RW · 5'9" · PSG · STARTING



Bradley Barcola

23 · \$54M

#12 · LW · 6'0" · PSG



Rayan Cherki

22 · \$49M

#24 · AM · 5'9" · Manchester City



Maghnes Aklouché

24 · \$32M

#25 · RW · 5'9" · Monaco



Jean-Philippe Mateta

28 · \$32M

#22 · ST · 6'2" · Crystal Palace



Marcus Thuram

28 · \$59M

#9 · ST · 6'4" · Inter Milan

Patrick Berg (c)

PB

28 · \$7M

#6 · DM · 5'10" · Bodø/Glimt · STARTING

Kristian Thorstvedt

KT

27 · \$13M

#18 · CM · 6'1" · Sassuolo · STARTING

Oscar Bobb

OB

22 · \$27M

#22 · RW · 5'7" · Fulham · STARTING

Thelo Aasgaard

TA

24 · \$9M

#19 · AM · 6'0" · Rangers · STARTING

Fredrik Aursnes

FA

30 · \$22M

#14 · CM/RB · 5'9" · Benfica · STARTING

Morten Thorsby

MT

29 · \$5M

#2 · CM · 6'2" · Cremonese

DEFENDERS

Kristoffer Ajer

KA

27 · \$19M

#3 · CB · 6'5" · Brentford

Leo Østigård

LØ

26 · \$13M

#4 · CB · 6'2" · Genoa · STARTING

David Møller Wolfe

DW

24 · \$11M

#5 · LB · 5'11" · Wolves

Fredrik Bjørkan

FB

27 · \$4M

#15 · LB · 5'10" · Bodø/Glimt · STARTING

Marcus Pedersen

MP

25 · \$9M

#16 · RB · 5'10" · Torino

Torbjørn Heggem

TH

27 · \$8M

MIDFIELDERS

Aurélien Tchouaméni

AT

26 · \$86M

#8 · DM · 6'1" · Real Madrid · STARTING

Manu Koné

MK

24 · \$27M

#15 · CM · 6'1" · Roma · STARTING

N'Golo Kanté

NK

35 · \$9M

#13 · DM · 5'6" · Al-Ittihad

Adrien Rabiot

AR

31 · \$27M

#14 · CM · 6'2" · AC Milan

Warren Zaïre-Emery

WZ

20 · \$65M

#18 · CM · 5'10" · PSG

DEFENDERS

Jules Koundé

JK

27 · \$65M

#5 · RB/CB · 5'10" · Barcelona · STARTING

Maxence Lacroix

ML

25 · \$38M

#26 · CB · 6'4" · Crystal Palace · STARTING

Dayot Upamecano

DU

26 · \$65M

#23 · CB · 6'1" · Bayern Munich · STARTING

Theo Hernández

TH

28 · \$43M

#19 · LB · 5'11" · Al Hilal · STARTING

William Saliba

WS

24 · \$97M

#4 · CB · 6'4" · Arsenal

Ibrahima Konaté

IK

26 · \$49M

#17 · CB · 6'4" · Liverpool

#17 · CB · 6'1" · Bologna

SL

Sondre Langås

25 · \$3M

#24 · CB · 6'3" · Derby County

HF

Henrik Falchener

23 · \$2M

#25 · CB · 6'2" · Viking · STARTING

JR

Julian Ryerson

28 · \$16M

#26 · RB · 5'10" · Dortmund

GOALKEEPERS

ES

Egil Selvik

28 · \$2M

#13 · GK · 6'3" · Watford · STARTING

ON

Ørjan Nyland

35 · \$3M

#1 · GK · 6'4" · Sevilla

ST

Sander Tangvik

23 · \$2M

#12 · GK · 6'4" · Hamburger SV

LH

Lucas Hernández

29 · \$27M

#21 · CB/LB · 6'0" · PSG

MG

Malo Gusto

22 · \$38M

#2 · RB · 5'9" · Chelsea

LD

Lucas Digne

32 · \$13M

#3 · LB · 5'10" · Aston Villa

GOALKEEPERS

MM

Mike Maignan

30 · \$38M

#16 · GK · 6'3" · AC Milan · STARTING

BS

Brice Samba

32 · \$9M

#1 · GK · 6'2" · Rennes

RR

Robin Risser

21 · \$16M

#23 · GK · 6'4" · Lens

Odds & Probabilities

Pre-lineup odds (worldcup-2026.bet, TheSpread, RefOdds). Post-rotation France price likely shorter — verify live before wagering.

Norway +400

~20% implied pre-lineup; effectively lower post-rotation.

Draw +360

~21.7% implied; less relevant with Norway B-team.

France -170

~63% implied pre-lineup; effective ~65–70% post-rotation.

O2.5 1.87 / U2.5 1.75

Market split; rotation shifts thesis toward Under.

Market	Pre-Lineup Price	Interpretation
Moneyline	NOR +400 / Draw +360 / FRA -170	France favored; rotation widens gap.
Total Goals	Over 2.5 @ 1.87 · Under 2.5 @ 1.75	Nearly even; B-team Norway pushes toward Under.
Both Teams to Score	Yes @ 1.76	BTTS No + France Win = Selection 2 thesis.
Core play reference	France Win & U3.5 @ min +120	Matches France 2-0 / 1-0 central paths.
Adjacent play	France CS combo @ min +200	Norway without Haaland/Ødegaard starting.

Quick guide: Decimal **1.87** = \$100 returns \$187 (\$87 profit). American **-170** = risk \$170 to win \$100. **+400** = risk \$100 to win \$400. **France Win & U3.5** requires France victory with 3 or fewer total goals. **BTTS No + France Win** = France win with Norway failing to score.

Risks

Late Lineup Change

Haaland or Ødegaard promoted to XI would shift thesis — monitor warmups.

Mbappé Fitness

Cancel both selections if Mbappé injured in warmup.

Weather

Heavy rain invalidates clean-sheet confidence; humidity already elevated.

Concentration Risk

70% on single combo — full budget loss possible on upset or 3+ goal shootout.

Maximum budget: \$100. Do not chase losses. Prior CS 2-1 selection remains CANCELLED. Minors prohibited from sports wagering where applicable.

Sources

- Sofascore — Confirmed lineups & tournament stats
- FIFA — World Cup 2026 Official
- FotMob — Squad & match data
- Sporting News — Match preview & odds context
- worldcup-2026.bet — Pre-lineup odds
- TheSpread — Odds comparison
- RefOdds — Referee & betting data
- Weather Underground — Foxborough forecast
- Transfermarkt — Norway squad values
- Transfermarkt — France squad values
- USA Today — World Cup coverage
- ECB — EUR/USD reference rate